

UbiSurfer

The New Board for Web Surfers!



The new 18 cm (7-inch) netbook, dubbed UbiSurfer, promises Internet buffs a swift and exhilarating Web-browsing experience, at a low price.

Web surfers in India can now feel an adrenaline rush with the richer and faster Web experience of UbiSurfer, a new 18 cm (7-inch) netbook with a Linux OS version, available in India for Rs 7,999 that comes with free mobile Internet for an year. The modified version of Debian that's been used on the UbiSurfer offers buyers a significant cost benefit.

'Fast and furious', yet economic

UbiSurfer, developed by wireless Web access products maker Datawind, offers a strong value proposition: good Internet speeds at a low price. This hand-held/portable device is thus a good buy for those who need to access the Internet on the move, and even for those planning to buy a netbook. Datawind has used cloud computing and its patented client/server architecture to deliver the power of a monster server, in the palm of your hand. Even better, the firm worked on making both the hardware and usage costs highly affordable. UbiSurfer comes bundled with 30 hours per month of free Internet access (for the first year), that is usable across India. At an average price of Rs 500

per month, regular Internet access plans would otherwise cost Rs 6,000 per year!

Says Suneet S Tuli, CEO, Datawind, "So that there are no surprises, there is a timer on the home page, clearly indicating how much time the customer has clocked up each month. Customers will even get a pop-up reminding them that they're nearing their limit, when they reach 29 hours. At 30 hours, access is simply restricted until the start of the next month. Nobody bills the user; so the customer gets no surprise bills. The customer can top-up by calling our toll-free line. Note that even though the CDMA access is restricted, the customer can choose to continue using the Internet freely over the Wi-Fi network."

"UbiSurfer [also] offers an uninterrupted Internet connection that allows the user to explore the Web free of cost for one year, and at a reasonable price of Rs 999 thereafter. If you add the annual cost of an Internet connection for the low-cost entry-level netbooks in India, you will realise that their cost advantage gets diluted down the road. UbiSurfer promises a richer and faster Web experience at one-third the total package cost (Internet connection plus device price) of